

Individual Project

Tamzid Kazim  
10606752

Understanding Buyer Behaviour

Edith Cowan University  
University of Portsmouth

## **Executive Summary**

This report explores the complex connection between consumer personality traits and purchasing patterns, highlighting how trait theory may be used to better understand consumer behavior. We investigated the ways in which individual personalities, as identified by the 16 Personalities test (16 Personalities, n.d.), impact fashion purchase decisions through cooperative analysis with team members from Edith Cowan University (ECU) and the University of Portsmouth (UoP). A thorough analysis of the parallels and contrasts in our purchasing habits between my personality type, Protagonist (ENFJ), and that of a chosen team member, Campaigner (ENFP). For marketers looking to customize methods that appeal to a variety of customer categories, the findings provide insightful information.

The results show that structure, spontaneity, value-seeking, and information processing all have an impact on our fashion buying behavior, resulting in both similarities and differences. The marketing ramifications for businesses aiming to reach comparable client categories are investigated using these findings. According to the report's findings, marketers may better target their ads, develop closer bonds with customers, and customize their tactics by having a better grasp of personality-driven purchasing behavior.

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## **Introduction**

Knowing what influences people's decisions to buy is essential for effective marketing in today's fiercely competitive and customer- focused economy. The psychological foundations, especially personality traits, frequently give the most predictive knowledge of consumer behavior, even while demographic parameters like age, wealth, and culture provide superficial insights (Armstrong & Kotler, 2020). Brands that understand that personality affects everything from product choice to purchasing behavior may better adjust their tactics to align with consumer incentives (Mihic et al., 2013).

By examining the similarities and differences amongst purchasers according to their personality profiles, this research investigates the use of trait theory in consumer behavior. The investigation's setting is a cooperative exercise in which students from the University of Portsmouth (UoP) and Edith Cowan University (ECU) shared information on a recent fashion buy and finished the 16 Personalities exam. A comparative study of consumer personalities and behaviors within a culturally varied population was made possible by the data that was produced.

This report contrasts Sofia's (Campaigner, ENFP) and mine (Protagonist, ENFJ) personality types, emphasizing how our differences in structure and decision-making affect our buying habits and how we share attributes like extraversion and intuition (McCrae & Costa, 1999). The study demonstrates how psychological variations influence customer involvement by examining our fashion purchases and purchasing patterns.

An introduction to trait theory, its evolution, and its uses in marketing is given at the outset. A synopsis of each team member's personality traits and purchases follows. Theory is applied to actual customer behavior through a thorough comparison between Sofia and myself, which sparks a conversation on marketing implications and tactics for personality-driven consumer targeting.

### Thesis Statement:

This report shows that even closely related personality types display unique consumer behaviors by using Trait Theory to analyze real-world fashion purchases. By comprehending these subtleties, marketers may create more individualized and successful marketing campaigns.

This investigation makes it clear that personality-based segmentation offers a deeper, more complex understanding of consumer behavior than traditional demographic profiling, underscoring the psychological profiling's increasing significance in contemporary marketing (Schiffman et al., 2020).

## **Theory Overview and Analysis**

### Development of Trait Theory:

According to the psychological paradigm known as trait theory, personality is made up of general inclinations or qualities that hold true in many contexts and throughout time. One of the first pioneers was Gordon Allport (1937), who was later expanded upon by Raymond Cattell and Hans Eysenck (Novikova, 2013). The Big Five is now the most popular model and comprises:

- i. Openness to Experience
- ii. Conscientiousness
- iii. Extraversion
- iv. Agreeableness

v. Neuroticism

Due to its ability to forecast customer behavior patterns, this model has become a cornerstone of marketing and consumer behavior research.

### Personality Measurement Tools

Personality characteristics are measured via a range of tools:

- I. The Big Five Inventory (BFI) assesses the five main aspects of personality.
- II. The Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) uses four characteristics to classify people into sixteen kinds.
- III. The 16 Personalities Test is a well-liked MBTI modification that additionally incorporates Big Five insights.

### Benefits and Limitations of Trait Theory

#### Benefits:

- I. Provides a model of customer behavior that is predictable.
- II. Allows for personality-based market segmentation.
- III. Facilitates personalizing marketing messages.

#### Limitations:

- I. Tends to overlook cultural and social context.
- II. Simplifies complicated people into static characteristics.
- III. In certain academic areas, instruments like the MBTI have come under fire for being unreliable.

## Team Members and Justification

| Name                     | Personality Type  | Recent Purchase                       | Details/ Grading                     | Shopping Habit                               | Origin          |
|--------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Thukatof Thukatoe</b> | Commander (ENTJ)  | Shirt from Shein                      | Design: 8<br>Quality: 5<br>Price: 10 | Very Spontaneous Online preferred            | Myanmar         |
| <b>Daniel Spangehl</b>   | Mediator (INFP)   | Jumper                                | Design: 7<br>Quality: 10<br>Price: 8 | In Person Shopper                            | South Africa    |
| <b>Daniel Mitchell</b>   | Architect (INTJ)  | Neckless                              | Design: 6<br>Quality: 7<br>Price: 9  | Preferred online than in person, Spontaneous | London, England |
| <b>Nathan Pierre</b>     | Campaigner (ENFP) | Bundle Clothes from Shein             | Design: 8<br>Quality: 6<br>Price: 9  | Online Bulk Ordering, Budget Shopper         | England         |
| <b>Sofia Watt</b>        | Campaigner (ENFP) | Metalic Blue Shirt and Pants (online) | Design: 10<br>Quality: 8<br>Price: 5 | Online (Judged by reviews), Semi-            | Dunsborough, WA |

|                         |                       |                                          |                                      |                                                             |            |
|-------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
|                         |                       |                                          |                                      | Spontaneous                                                 |            |
| <b>Tamzid<br/>Kazim</b> | Protagonist<br>(ENFJ) | Nike Air<br>Force 1<br>(Grey)<br>from JD | Design: 10<br>Quality: 9<br>Price: 8 | Preferred<br>In-person<br>shopping,<br>Semi-<br>Spontaneous | Bangladesh |

(All the gradings are from 1- 10, least to most concerned)

#### Justification for choosing Sofia Watt:

I choose Sofia (Campaigner, ENFP) because, other from one crucial dimension judging vs. perceiving, her personality is almost exactly like mine (ENFJ). Our ability to deliberate or make impulsive judgments is impacted by this slight disparity. Although we are both outgoing, perceptive, and sympathetic, I like order and preparation, whereas she prefers spontaneity. This provides an ideal comparative analysis of how little changes in personality impact purchasing decisions.

## **Theory Application**

When trait theory is applied to our fashion buying habits, it becomes clear that even minor personality variations might influence unique consumer paths. Extrovert, perceptive, and sympathetic, Sofia and I share these qualities, which affect expressive and emotionally impactful purchasing judgments. But the main factor that clearly directs our decision- making is the Judging (ENFJ) vs. Perceiving (ENFP) axis. This is in line with the findings of Mulyanegara et al. (2007), who highlighted that personality traits have a direct impact on how customers assess, choose, and react emotionally to fashion purchases.

#### Myself, Tamzid Kazim (Protagonist: ENFJ)

I take a methodical and values-based approach to fashion as an ENFJ. My purchases are frequently motivated by social concern, long-term happiness, and identity



expression. Before making a purchase, I frequently ask friends or consider how an item fits with my larger ideals in order to find balance between aesthetic appeal, moral alignment (such as sustainability or ethical sourcing), and social approbation. This indicates a high degree of conscientiousness and agreeableness, two of the Big Five qualities that promote reliable, moral consumer behavior.

Additionally, I exhibit a modest level of risk aversion, making sure that purchases are thoughtful and realistically justified. Evoking judging-oriented features that favor planning and decisiveness, my shopping activity strikes a balance between the ease of purchasing online and the tactile pleasures of in-store shopping, where I can assess the quality and authenticity of things personally (Myers- Briggs Overview, 2023)

#### Sofia Watt (Campaigner: ENFP)

The impulsive, trend-sensitive, and emotionally adventurous consumer profile is embodied by Sofia, an ENFP. Her quest for uniqueness and colorful self-expression is shown in her purchase of a metallic blue top and jeans. Her greater risk tolerance and willingness to try out daring looks are consistent with ENFP's tendency to value experiences above results. Her decision-making is intuitive and flexible, frequently influenced more by a "feels- good" moment, consumer feedback, and visual appeal than by a methodical assessment.

Because of the diversity and inspiration they provide, Sofia prefers to choose online platforms. This inclination reinforces the perceiving trait's propensity for adaptability and unrestricted exploration, which marketers may capitalize on by utilizing dynamic trends and creative branding techniques.

#### Comparative Analysis: Structured Identity vs. Spontaneous Expression

| <b>Trait/ Catagory</b> | <b>Tamzid (ENFJ)</b>              | <b>Sofia (ENFP)</b>              |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Decision Style</b>  | Planned, Reflective               | Spontaneous, Intuitive           |
| <b>Shopping Method</b> | Primarily In- store, Often Online | Primarily Online, Often In-store |

|                          |                               |                           |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>Primary Influence</b> | Friends, Values, Self-Concept | Reviews, Creativity, Mood |
| <b>Risk Management</b>   | Moderate                      | High                      |
| <b>Budget Management</b> | Value and Quality Conscious   | Design and Trend Oriented |
| <b>Emotional Trait</b>   | Identity Affirmation          | Self Expression and Joy   |

Although we both appreciate emotional depth and genuineness in our purchases, Sofia thrives on novelty and creative freedom, while I look for restrained expression that is consistent with my social and personal ideals. Our competing Judging vs. Perceiving qualities determine how we reach the ultimate decision, while our common extraversion and intuition lead us toward expressive consumption.

Furthermore, these personality manifestations are amplified by the cultural environment. Sofia's Australian individualism promotes her creative and experimental impulses, whereas my collectivist Bangladeshi background encourages socially conscious, moderate purchasing habits (Minkov, 2013). This interaction between culture and personality strengthens trait theory's ability to explain phenomena in practical settings.

## Marketing Implications

Beyond conventional demographic segmentation, marketers may gain a significant psychographic perspective by comprehending personality types like ENFJ and ENFP.

### For ENFJ (Protagonist):

ENFJ's have a strong sense of purpose, empathy, and values. Emotional storytelling, social responsibility, and brand authenticity should be the main focuses of marketing initiatives. Trust and emotional alignment are fostered by campaigns that highlight ethical principles, such as sustainability or fair trade sourcing. Facebook and YouTube are good platforms for long-form tales that show the influence on the

community and common ideals. These customers are more inclined to identify their identities with a cause-driven company and end up becoming brand evangelists.

#### For ENFP (Campaigner):

ENFP's love to express themselves, be creative, and be new. They respond very well to visually appealing, trend-forward content because of their impulsive nature. To pique interest, marketing could highlight limited-edition releases, product diversity, and novel experiences. Platforms for short-form videos, such as TikTok and Instagram Reels, are perfect for lively, dynamic storytelling. Engagement is further increased through partnerships with influencers that represent individuality and creativity.

#### Cultural Consideration:

Personality expression is considerably moderated by cultural setting. Sofia, from individualistic Australia, exhibits personal independence and assertiveness in consumption, whereas I, as a Bangladeshi consumer, came from a collectivist culture that encourages humility, social harmony, and mindful consumption. The necessity of culturally responsive marketing is further supported by this contradiction. Because cultures influence not only what people purchase, but also why and how they buy it, marketers must modify personality-driven ads inside frameworks that resonate with their target audience.

#### Strategic Integration:

- Use psychographic profiling powered by AI to customize product suggestions.
- Create customized product lines to appeal to consumers who are principled and expressive.
- For comprehensive targeting, segment campaigns using coated insights: personality+ culture+ lifestyle.

In the end, companies may cultivate more emotional loyalty and behavioral impact across a variety of markets by acknowledging the interaction between trait-based behaviors and cultural context.

## **Conclusion**

This report provides a deep lens through which marketers may better comprehend the human psychology underlying purchasing decisions, highlighting the complex but potent impact of personality in influencing customer behavior. It is clear from comparing the ENFJ (Protagonist) and ENFP (Campaigner) personality types that even little personality differences, such as judging vs perceiving, can result in notably different customer experiences. Despite the fact that both profiles are expressive, perceptive, and emotionally motivated, their differences in spontaneity and structure show how personality characteristics affect everything from decision-making processes to purchasing platforms.

Crucially, this report demonstrates that personality-driven segmentation yields more profound and useful insights than traditional demographics alone. It emphasizes how psychographics are becoming more and more important in a multicultural workplace where cultural background may either enhance or temper personality traits. The ramifications for marketers are obvious: culturally sensitive customisation grounded in personality theory may promote long-term resonance, brand loyalty, and meaningful engagement.

Understanding the psychological aspects of consumer decisions is not only enlightening, but also crucial in a society where options are as varied as people's

identities. This study shows how connecting personality theory with marketing techniques enables companies to inspire deep, values-based interactions rather than just sell goods.

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## Appendix



(Team Meeting took place on March 23, 2025 6:15 am AWST)

(All references were accessed on April 5, 2025 12:55 pm AWST)